Laptop Support Knowledge Base

Troubleshooting guides, FAQs and policies for AI customer support (RAG)

Version 1.0 | Applies to Windows, macOS and Linux laptops unless stated otherwise

Items in [SQUARE BRACKETS] are placeholders. Replace them with your company's real details before indexing.

How to use this document

Each troubleshooting entry is a self-contained section with a unique Doc ID, category, symptoms, causes, numbered steps and an escalation rule. Sections are kept short so they work well as retrieval chunks. The assistant should ask the customer for the laptop model, operating system and what changed recently before giving steps, and should always walk through steps one at a time.

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1. Power and Battery

LS-PWR-001: Laptop will not turn on

Category: Power | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PWR-001

Symptoms:

- No lights, no fan sound, black screen after pressing the power button
- Lights come on but nothing displays

Common causes:

- Fully drained battery
- Faulty charger or cable
- Power-state glitch
- Failed hardware component

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Plug in the original charger directly to a wall socket (not a power strip) and leave it for 30 minutes.
2. Check the charger's LED and the cable for damage; try a different socket.
3. Remove all USB devices, SD cards and docks.
4. Perform a hard reset: unplug the charger, hold the power button for 15 to 30 seconds, plug in the charger and press power. If the battery is removable, remove it first.
5. Look for a charging LED on the laptop. If it is off or blinking in a pattern, note the pattern.
6. Try connecting an external monitor to check whether only the screen is faulty.

Escalate to human support if:

there is still no sign of power after the hard reset and a known-good charger, there is a burning smell, or the case is hot or swollen.

LS-PWR-002: Laptop not charging or 'plugged in, not charging'

Category: Power | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PWR-002

Symptoms:

- Battery percentage does not increase while plugged in
- Message says 'Plugged in, not charging'

Common causes:

- Wrong wattage charger
- Damaged cable or charging port
- Battery protection mode
- Outdated BIOS or battery driver

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Confirm the charger wattage matches the label on the original adapter.
2. Inspect the charging port for dust, bent pins or looseness; clean gently with a dry soft brush.
3. Try another socket and cable.
4. Windows: open Device Manager, expand Batteries, uninstall 'Microsoft ACPI-Compliant Control Method Battery', then restart.
5. Do a hard reset (see LS-PWR-001).
6. Check the manufacturer site for a BIOS or firmware update.
7. If battery health in the manufacturer app shows 'Replace', the battery needs replacement.

Escalate to human support if:

the charger tests fine on another laptop, the charging port is loose, or the battery health is reported as poor.

LS-PWR-003: Battery drains quickly

Category: Power | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PWR-003

Symptoms:

- Battery lasts under 2 hours with normal use
- Percentage drops suddenly or shuts down at 20 to 30 percent

Common causes:

- Battery wear from age (typically after 300 to 500 charge cycles)
- Heavy background apps
- High screen brightness
- Power plan set to maximum performance

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Lower screen brightness and enable battery saver or low power mode.
2. Windows: Settings > System > Power & battery > Battery usage to see top apps. macOS: System Settings > Battery.
3. Close or disable heavy startup apps (Task Manager > Startup).
4. Turn off Bluetooth, keyboard backlight and unused USB devices.
5. Generate a battery report. Windows: run 'powercfg /batteryreport' in Command Prompt and compare Design Capacity to Full Charge Capacity.
6. If full charge capacity is below about 60 percent of design capacity, replace the battery.

Escalate to human support if:

the battery health is poor, the laptop shuts off suddenly with charge remaining, or the battery is under warranty.

LS-PWR-004: Swollen or overheating battery (SAFETY)

Category: Power / Safety | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PWR-004

Symptoms:

- Trackpad lifts or does not click properly
- Case bulging or gaps appearing
- Unusual smell or extreme heat from the underside

Common causes:

- Aging or damaged lithium-ion battery

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Stop using the laptop immediately and unplug the charger.
2. Do not press on, puncture or try to flatten the battery.
3. Place the laptop on a hard, non-flammable surface away from anything flammable.
4. Do not travel with it or leave it charging.
5. Contact authorised service for battery replacement.

Escalate to human support if:

always. This is a safety issue and must be escalated to a human agent and an authorised service centre right away.

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2. Performance and Heat

LS-PRF-001: Laptop is slow

Category: Performance | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PRF-001

Symptoms:

- Apps take long to open
- Typing or mouse lag
- Long boot time

Common causes:

- Too many startup programs
- Low free disk space (under 10 percent)
- Low RAM
- Malware
- Old hard drive (HDD) instead of SSD
- Pending updates

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Restart the laptop (a full restart, not sleep).
2. Open Task Manager (Ctrl+Shift+Esc) or Activity Monitor and sort by CPU, Memory and Disk to find heavy apps.
3. Disable unneeded startup apps.
4. Free up disk space: delete temporary files, empty the recycle bin, uninstall unused apps.
5. Install pending OS and driver updates.
6. Run a malware scan (see LS-SEC-001).
7. If the laptop uses an HDD, upgrading to an SSD gives the largest speed improvement. If RAM use is constantly above 85 percent, consider adding RAM if supported.

Escalate to human support if:

performance does not improve after all steps or the disk shows errors or SMART warnings.

LS-PRF-002: Laptop overheating or fan is very loud

Category: Performance / Heat | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PRF-002

Symptoms:

- Fan runs at high speed constantly
- Bottom or keyboard area very hot
- Sudden shutdowns or throttling

Common causes:

- Blocked vents
- Dust buildup
- Soft surfaces like beds or sofas
- Heavy CPU or GPU load
- Dried thermal paste on older laptops

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Use the laptop on a hard, flat surface; consider a cooling pad.
2. Make sure vents on the sides and bottom are not blocked.
3. Check Task Manager or Activity Monitor for apps using high CPU.
4. Update BIOS and graphics drivers.
5. Use the Balanced power plan instead of maximum performance.
6. Clean vents with compressed air in short bursts with the laptop powered off. Do not open the case unless authorised to.

Escalate to human support if:

overheating continues after cleaning vents, the laptop shuts down on its own, or the thermal paste or fan likely needs servicing.

LS-PRF-003: Laptop freezes or hangs

Category: Performance | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PRF-003

Symptoms:

- Screen stops responding
- Mouse moves but nothing opens
- Needs forced shutdown

Common causes:

- Driver conflict
- Overheating
- Failing storage
- Low memory
- Faulty software

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Wait 2 minutes to see whether it recovers.
2. Press Ctrl+Alt+Del (Windows) or Cmd+Option+Esc (macOS) and end the unresponsive app.
3. If fully frozen, hold the power button for 10 seconds to force shutdown, then restart.
4. Boot into Safe Mode and check if the problem persists (if not, a driver or app is the cause).
5. Update the OS, BIOS and graphics driver; uninstall recently installed software.
6. Run disk check: Windows 'chkdsk /f' or macOS Disk Utility First Aid.

Escalate to human support if:

freezes keep happening in Safe Mode, which suggests a hardware fault.

LS-PRF-004: 100 percent disk usage

Category: Performance | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-PRF-004

Symptoms:

- Task Manager shows disk at or near 100 percent
- System becomes unresponsive

Common causes:

- Windows Search indexing
- Antivirus scan
- Windows Update
- HDD health issues

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Open Task Manager and identify the process using the disk.
2. Wait for updates or scans to finish.
3. Temporarily pause Windows Search indexing and see if usage drops.
4. Run chkdsk to check disk errors.
5. Consider replacing an HDD with an SSD.

Escalate to human support if:

disk usage stays at 100 percent after these steps or the drive reports health errors.

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3. Display

LS-DSP-001: Black or blank screen

Category: Display | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-DSP-001

Symptoms:

- Laptop seems on (lights, fan) but screen is black
- Screen turns off randomly

Common causes:

- Display brightness at zero
- Sleep or hibernate stuck
- Graphics driver issue
- Loose display cable
- Failed screen

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Press a key and increase the brightness keys.
2. Hold the power button 15 seconds to force shutdown, then power on.
3. Connect an external monitor. If it shows an image, the laptop screen or its cable is faulty.
4. Windows: press Win+Ctrl+Shift+B to restart the graphics driver.
5. Boot into Safe Mode and reinstall the graphics driver.
6. Shine a flashlight at the screen; if you can faintly see the desktop, the backlight has failed.

Escalate to human support if:

the external monitor works but the laptop screen does not, or there is no display on either.

LS-DSP-002: Screen flickering or lines on screen

Category: Display | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-DSP-002

Symptoms:

- Flickering or flashing
- Horizontal or vertical lines
- Colour distortion

Common causes:

- Outdated or corrupt graphics driver
- Wrong refresh rate
- Damaged display cable or panel

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check whether flicker appears in the BIOS or on an external monitor; if yes, it is hardware.
2. Update or reinstall the graphics driver.
3. Set refresh rate to the recommended value in Display Settings.
4. Disable HDR or adaptive brightness temporarily.
5. Gently open and close the lid; if the flicker changes with the hinge angle, the display cable is likely worn.

Escalate to human support if:

lines or flicker appear in BIOS, or change with lid movement.

LS-DSP-003: External monitor or projector not detected

Category: Display | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-DSP-003

Symptoms:

- No signal on the external display
- Wrong resolution or only mirrored

Common causes:

- Loose cable
- Wrong input source
- Outdated graphics driver
- Incorrect display mode

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Re-seat the cable at both ends; try another cable or port (HDMI, USB-C, DisplayPort).
2. Select the correct input on the monitor.
3. Windows: press Win+P and choose Extend or Duplicate. macOS: System Settings > Displays > Detect Displays.
4. Update graphics drivers and restart.
5. For USB-C, confirm the port supports video output (look for a DisplayPort or Thunderbolt icon).

Escalate to human support if:

the external display is not detected with several known-good cables and ports.

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4. Network and Bluetooth

LS-NET-001: Wi-Fi not connecting or no internet

Category: Network | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-NET-001

Symptoms:

- Wi-Fi network not visible
- Connected but no internet
- Keeps disconnecting

Common causes:

- Airplane mode on
- Router issue
- Outdated network driver
- Incorrect password
- IP conflicts

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check airplane mode and the Wi-Fi function key.
2. Test another device on the same Wi-Fi to see if the router or ISP is down.
3. Restart the laptop and the router (unplug 30 seconds).
4. Forget the network and reconnect with the correct password.
5. Windows: run Network Troubleshooter; in Command Prompt run 'ipconfig /release', 'ipconfig /renew' and 'ipconfig /flushdns'.
6. Update or reinstall the Wi-Fi driver (download via another device or Ethernet if needed).
7. Try a different Wi-Fi band (2.4 GHz vs 5 GHz).

Escalate to human support if:

other networks work but this laptop never connects after a driver reinstall, or the Wi-Fi adapter is missing in Device Manager.

LS-NET-002: Slow Wi-Fi

Category: Network | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-NET-002

Symptoms:

- Pages load slowly
- Video buffering
- Low speed test results compared to other devices

Common causes:

- Distance from router
- Interference
- Too many connected devices
- Old Wi-Fi standard

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Move closer to the router and remove obstacles.
2. Switch to the 5 GHz band if available.
3. Run a speed test on another device to compare.
4. Close background downloads and cloud sync.
5. Update the Wi-Fi driver.
6. Use an Ethernet cable or USB adapter to confirm if the problem is the Wi-Fi card.

Escalate to human support if:

wired speeds are fine but Wi-Fi remains slow only on this laptop.

LS-NET-003: Bluetooth not working or devices not pairing

Category: Network | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-NET-003

Symptoms:

- Bluetooth toggle missing
- Devices fail to pair or disconnect

Common causes:

- Bluetooth off
- Outdated driver
- Device already paired elsewhere
- Interference

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Turn Bluetooth off and on; check airplane mode.
2. Remove the device from the paired list and pair again.
3. Put the accessory in pairing mode and keep it close.
4. Update or reinstall the Bluetooth driver and restart.
5. Windows: Settings > Bluetooth & devices > run the troubleshooter.

Escalate to human support if:

the Bluetooth adapter does not appear in Device Manager.

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5. Audio, Camera and Microphone

LS-AUD-001: No sound from laptop speakers

Category: Audio | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-AUD-001

Symptoms:

- No audio or crackling sound
- Sound only through headphones

Common causes:

- Muted volume
- Wrong output device
- Driver problem
- Headphone jack sensing error

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check volume and mute; unplug headphones.
2. Select the correct output device in Sound settings.
3. Run the audio troubleshooter.
4. Update or reinstall the audio driver and restart.
5. Disable 'Audio enhancements' in the device properties and test again.

Escalate to human support if:

audio is missing in all apps after driver reinstall, suggesting a speaker or audio chip fault.

LS-AUD-002: Microphone not working

Category: Audio | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-AUD-002

Symptoms:

- Others cannot hear you in calls
- Mic level shows no input

Common causes:

- App permissions blocked
- Mic muted by a key
- Wrong input device selected
- Driver issue

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check the microphone mute key (often F4 or F8).
2. Windows: Settings > Privacy & security > Microphone, allow apps access. macOS: System Settings > Privacy & Security > Microphone.
3. Select the correct input device and speak to see the input meter move.
4. Update the audio driver.
5. Test with a headset to rule out a hardware fault.

Escalate to human support if:

the laptop mic and a headset both fail.

LS-AUD-003: Webcam not working

Category: Camera | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-AUD-003

Symptoms:

- Black image
- 'Camera not found' or in-use error

Common causes:

- Privacy shutter or function key
- App permissions
- Another app using the camera
- Driver issue

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Open the physical privacy shutter and check the camera key.
2. Allow camera access in privacy settings.
3. Close other apps that may be using the camera.
4. Restart the laptop.
5. Update or reinstall the camera driver; check the BIOS to ensure the camera is enabled.

Escalate to human support if:

the camera is not listed in Device Manager or System Information.

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6. Keyboard and Touchpad

LS-INP-001: Keyboard keys not working or typing wrong characters

Category: Keyboard | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-INP-001

Symptoms:

- Some keys do nothing
- Wrong characters appear
- Keys stick

Common causes:

- Wrong keyboard language layout
- Num Lock or Fn lock
- Debris under keys
- Driver issue
- Liquid damage

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check the keyboard layout and language settings.
2. Toggle Fn Lock and Num Lock.
3. Restart the laptop.
4. Turn the laptop upside down and gently tap; use compressed air to remove debris.
5. Update the keyboard driver.
6. Use the on-screen keyboard to confirm whether the problem is hardware.
7. Test with an external USB keyboard.

Escalate to human support if:

keys remain dead after a restart, there has been liquid spillage, or keys are physically damaged.

LS-INP-002: Touchpad not responding or cursor jumps

Category: Touchpad | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-INP-002

Symptoms:

- Cursor does not move
- Gestures not working
- Cursor jumps while typing

Common causes:

- Touchpad disabled by key
- Driver problem
- Dirty surface
- Palm rejection settings

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Press the touchpad enable/disable key (often F6 or Fn+F7).
2. Check touchpad is enabled in Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Touchpad.
3. Clean the surface with a slightly damp, lint-free cloth.
4. Update or reinstall the touchpad driver.
5. Disconnect external mice that may cause conflicts.

Escalate to human support if:

touchpad clicks fail physically or it still does not respond after reinstalling drivers.

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7. Operating System and Software

LS-OS-001: Blue screen of death (BSOD) or system crash

Category: Operating System | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-OS-001

Symptoms:

- Blue screen with a stop code
- Random restarts

Common causes:

- Faulty driver
- Failing RAM or storage
- Overheating
- Bad update

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Note the stop code (for example 'CRITICAL_PROCESS_DIED' or 'IRQL_NOT_LESS_OR_EQUAL').
2. Disconnect external devices and restart.
3. Boot into Safe Mode and uninstall recent drivers, updates or software.
4. Run 'sfc /scannow' and 'DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /RestoreHealth' in an admin Command Prompt.
5. Run Windows Memory Diagnostic.
6. Use System Restore to return to a working state.

Escalate to human support if:

crashes continue after these steps or occur in Safe Mode.

LS-OS-002: Windows update stuck or failing

Category: Operating System | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-OS-002

Symptoms:

- Update stuck at a percentage
- Error codes during installation

Common causes:

- Corrupted update files
- Low disk space
- Network interruptions

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Wait at least one hour; updates can take long.
2. Make sure there is at least 20 GB of free space and the laptop is plugged in.
3. Run the Windows Update troubleshooter.
4. Restart and try again.
5. Reset update components or clear the SoftwareDistribution folder (advanced).
6. If necessary, install the update using the Windows Update Assistant.

Escalate to human support if:

the update keeps failing with the same error code after these steps.

LS-OS-003: Forgot laptop password or locked out

Category: Operating System / Account | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-OS-003

Symptoms:

- Cannot sign in
- Account locked

Common causes:

- Forgotten password
- Caps Lock enabled
- Account sign-in issues

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Check Caps Lock and keyboard layout.
2. If using a Microsoft or Apple ID, reset the password using the recovery option on another device.
3. Use a PIN, security questions or a password reset disk if available.
4. For work laptops, contact the company IT department for a reset.
5. Never ask the customer to share their password with the assistant.

Escalate to human support if:

the customer cannot prove ownership or the laptop is managed by an organisation.

LS-OS-004: Laptop stuck in boot loop or 'Operating system not found'

Category: Operating System | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-OS-004

Symptoms:

- Repeated restarts
- Message 'No bootable device' or 'Operating system not found'

Common causes:

- Corrupt OS files
- Wrong boot order
- Failing drive
- Failed update

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Remove all USB drives and external devices.
2. Enter BIOS (commonly F2, F10, Del or Esc) and verify the internal drive is listed and first in boot order.
3. Windows: boot into Recovery Environment (power off three times during start) and choose Startup Repair.
4. Try System Restore or 'Uninstall latest update' in advanced options.
5. Back up data using a bootable USB if possible before any reset.
6. As a last resort, reset the PC or reinstall the operating system.

Escalate to human support if:

the drive is not detected in BIOS or startup repair fails.

LS-OS-005: Storage almost full

Category: Operating System / Storage | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-OS-005

Symptoms:

- Low disk space warning
- Cannot install updates

Common causes:

- Large files
- Temporary files
- Old backups
- Duplicate downloads

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Use Storage settings (Windows) or Manage Storage (macOS) to view what takes space.
2. Empty the recycle bin and downloads folder.
3. Run Disk Cleanup or Storage Sense.
4. Uninstall unused apps and games.
5. Move photos and videos to cloud storage or an external drive.
6. Keep at least 15 percent of the drive free.

Escalate to human support if:

the customer wants a hardware storage upgrade; guide them to compatible options or authorised service.

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8. Ports, Storage and Peripherals

LS-HW-001: USB ports not working

Category: Hardware | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-HW-001

Symptoms:

- USB devices not detected
- Port charges but no data

Common causes:

- Power management settings
- Driver issue
- Dirty or damaged port
- Faulty device

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Try another USB port and another device.
2. Restart the laptop.
3. Windows: Device Manager > Universal Serial Bus controllers > uninstall and restart.
4. Disable 'allow the computer to turn off this device to save power' for USB hubs.
5. Inspect the port for debris or bent pins.

Escalate to human support if:

all ports fail or a port is physically damaged.

LS-HW-002: Laptop does not recognise external hard drive or SD card

Category: Hardware / Storage | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-HW-002

Symptoms:

- Drive not visible in File Explorer or Finder
- Prompt to format the drive

Common causes:

- Drive has no drive letter
- Power shortage
- Corrupt file system
- Faulty cable

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Try another cable and port; plug directly instead of using a hub.
2. Check Disk Management (Windows) or Disk Utility (macOS) to see if the drive is listed.
3. Assign a drive letter if it shows without one.
4. Do not format the drive if the customer needs the data.
5. Try the drive on another computer.

Escalate to human support if:

the drive makes clicking noises or the customer needs data recovery.

LS-HW-003: Strange noises from laptop (clicking, grinding, buzzing)

Category: Hardware | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-HW-003

Symptoms:

- Clicking from the drive
- Grinding fan
- Buzzing coil whine

Common causes:

- Failing HDD
- Fan obstruction or wear
- Coil whine from components

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Identify when the noise occurs (boot, load, idle).
2. Back up important data immediately if the clicking comes from an HDD.
3. Clean vents and check the fan (see LS-PRF-002).
4. Coil whine is usually harmless; changing the power plan can reduce it.

Escalate to human support if:

clicking or grinding continues; recommend urgent data backup and service.

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9. Security

LS-SEC-001: Suspected virus or malware

Category: Security | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-SEC-001

Symptoms:

- Pop-ups, unknown programs, browser redirects
- Unexpected slowdown
- Antivirus warnings

Common causes:

- Malicious downloads or email attachments
- Unsafe browser extensions

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Disconnect from the internet if the behaviour looks severe.
2. Run a full scan with Microsoft Defender or another trusted antivirus.
3. Uninstall unknown programs and browser extensions.
4. Change important passwords from a different, clean device.
5. Keep the OS and apps updated and enable real-time protection.
6. Back up important files before a reset if infection persists.

Escalate to human support if:

there is ransomware, financial theft, or the problem returns after cleaning.

LS-SEC-002: Lost or stolen laptop

Category: Security | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-SEC-002

Symptoms:

- Laptop missing

Common causes:

- Theft or misplacement

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Use Find My Device (Windows) or Find My (macOS) to locate, lock or erase the laptop.
2. Change passwords for email, banking and cloud accounts.
3. Report the theft to local police and obtain a report number.
4. Notify your employer if it is a work device.
5. Contact the manufacturer for warranty or insurance information.

Escalate to human support if:

always escalate to a human agent.

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10. Maintenance Best Practices

LS-MNT-001: Keeping your laptop healthy

Category: Maintenance | Device type: Laptop | Doc ID: LS-MNT-001

Symptoms:

- General preventive advice

Common causes:

- Neglected maintenance

Troubleshooting steps:

1. Restart at least once a week.
2. Install OS, driver and BIOS updates regularly.
3. Keep battery between 20 and 80 percent when possible; avoid leaving it at 100 percent plugged in for months.
4. Clean vents and keyboard every few months.
5. Back up data using the 3-2-1 rule: 3 copies, 2 different media, 1 offsite.
6. Use a quality surge protector and the original charger.
7. Do not eat or drink over the laptop; carry it in a padded bag.

Escalate to human support if:

not applicable.

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11. Warranty, Repair and Returns

Replace all placeholders with your company's actual policy before indexing.

LS-POL-001: Warranty coverage

Category: Policy | Doc ID: LS-POL-001

- Standard warranty period: [12 / 24 months] from the date of purchase.
- Covered: manufacturing defects, battery defects within [period], faulty display, keyboard, motherboard and ports under normal use.
- Not covered: accidental damage, liquid spills, cracked screens, unauthorised repairs, software issues and normal battery wear.
- Proof of purchase and the laptop serial number are required for all claims.
- Extended warranty or accidental damage protection: [details].

LS-POL-002: How to raise a repair request

Category: Policy | Doc ID: LS-POL-002

- Collect the customer's name, order number, serial number (found on the sticker under the laptop or via 'wmic bios get serialnumber'), and a description of the issue.
- Create a service ticket at [SUPPORT PORTAL URL] or by calling [PHONE NUMBER].
- Back up data before sending the laptop; the company is not responsible for data loss.
- Typical repair time: [5 to 10 business days]. Pickup or drop-off options: [details].
- Support hours: [e.g., Mon to Sat, 9 AM to 6 PM IST]. Email: [SUPPORT EMAIL].

LS-POL-003: Returns and refunds

Category: Policy | Doc ID: LS-POL-003

- Return window: [7 / 10 / 30 days] from delivery for unused or defective items.
- Item must be in original packaging with all accessories and invoice.
- Refunds are issued to the original payment method within [5 to 7 business days] after inspection.
- Replacement is offered for dead-on-arrival units confirmed by support.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

LS-FAQ-001: How often should I charge my laptop battery?

There is no need to drain it fully. Charging between 20 and 80 percent is best for long-term battery health, but regular full charges are fine for everyday use.

LS-FAQ-002: Is it okay to leave my laptop plugged in all the time?

Modern laptops stop charging at 100 percent, so it is generally safe. For long-term health, use the manufacturer's battery care or charge limit feature if available.

LS-FAQ-003: Can I use a different charger?

Use the original charger or one with the same voltage and at least the same wattage. Using the wrong voltage can damage the laptop. USB-C laptops should use certified USB-C Power Delivery chargers of sufficient wattage.

LS-FAQ-004: How do I find my laptop's serial number or model?

Check the sticker on the underside. On Windows, press Win+R, type 'msinfo32' and read System Model. On macOS, click the Apple menu and choose About This Mac.

LS-FAQ-005: How do I back up my data?

Use cloud storage (OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud) or an external drive. Windows has File History and macOS has Time Machine.

LS-FAQ-006: How do I restart a frozen laptop?

Hold the power button for about 10 seconds until it shuts off, wait a few seconds, then power on.

LS-FAQ-007: How do I enter BIOS or boot menu?

Restart and repeatedly press the manufacturer key during startup: commonly F2, F10, F12, Del or Esc.

LS-FAQ-008: How do I factory reset my laptop?

Windows: Settings > System > Recovery > Reset this PC. macOS: System Settings > General > Transfer or Reset > Erase All Content and Settings. Back up data first.

LS-FAQ-009: How much RAM do I need?

8 GB is the practical minimum for everyday use, 16 GB for multitasking and light creative work, 32 GB or more for heavy editing, development or virtual machines.

LS-FAQ-010: Should I replace my HDD with an SSD?

Yes, if your laptop supports it. An SSD makes startup and app loading much faster and is more shock-resistant.

13. Escalation and Safety Rules for the AI Assistant

LS-ESC-001: When to hand over to a human agent

Category: Assistant policy | Doc ID: LS-ESC-001

- Any safety risk: swollen battery, burning smell, smoke, sparks, overheating case, liquid spill while powered on. Tell the customer to power off and unplug if safe to do so.
- Warranty disputes, refunds, payment or order issues, and legal questions.
- Lost or stolen devices and suspected account compromise.
- Data recovery requests or failing drive symptoms such as clicking noises.
- The customer is frustrated, has already tried the steps, or asks for a human.
- The issue is not covered in this knowledge base. Do not guess; say so and offer escalation.
- Never ask for or store passwords, full card numbers or OTPs.
- Never advise opening the laptop case or replacing internal components unless the customer is an authorised technician; recommend authorised service instead.
- Give steps one at a time, confirm the result of each step, and ask for the laptop model and OS first if unknown.